Small Research Grant Application

Complete all four parts of this form and return it with your CV before 15 January 2027. Incomplete applications will not be reviewed.

Part I. Applicant

Name of applicant	Position
Dr Ilse Varga-Mendes	Senior Lecturer

Institution and department: University of Northmere, Department of Marine Biology

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Part II. Project

Project title: Sediment, light and the decline of seagrass in the Skarvik estuary

Duration	Proposed start date
24 months	1 April 2027

☐ Pilot study ☒ Field research ☐ Equipment only ☐ Publication support

Summary

Seagrass meadows store carbon, shelter juvenile fish and protect the shoreline from erosion. This project will measure how much light reaches the meadows of one estuary and relate it to the sediment carried by the river.

The estuary has never been surveyed systematically, although local fishers report a steady loss of meadow since the channels were deepened.

Objectives

The project has three objectives:

(a) to map the extent of seagrass meadows in the Skarvik estuary using drone imagery and ground-truth transects;

(b) to measure how sediment load affects shoot density, in particular:

- (i) after spring floods,
- (ii) near the two dredged shipping channels, and
- (iii) in the sheltered northern bays used as a reference;

(c) to share a monitoring protocol that volunteer groups can repeat every summer.

Part III. Budget

Item	Amount (EUR)		
	Year 1	Year 2	Total
Personnel			
Research assistant, 0.5 FTE	14,200	14,600	28,800
Student fieldwork stipends	3,000	3,000	6,000
Equipment			
Water-quality sonde	6,850	—	6,850
Laboratory sample freezer	4,100	—	4,100
Travel and fieldwork			
Boat hire, 12 days per year	2,400	2,400	4,800
Conference attendance	—	1,250	1,250
Total requested	**30,550**	**21,250**	**51,800**

Overheads are not eligible and must not be included in the amounts above.

Part IV. Declaration

I confirm that the information given in this application is complete and accurate. I agree that the Foundation may share a summary of the project with its reviewers.

Signature
I. Varga-Mendes

Date
9 December 2026

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Received	Reference	Reviewer	Decision